When you look at a chart and see Mercury or Venus conjunct the Sun and in direct motion, you know they are moving at their fastest daily speed. If you see that they are retrograde and conjunct the Sun, you know that they are slower than average. The slowest motion occurs at both station points.

DETERMINING SPEED AND DAILY MOTION

There is software for calculating the speed of each planet on any given date. If you know the average daily motion, you can determine if, on that day, the planet is traveling faster or slower than its daily rate. Some programs will also note if the planet is increasing or decreasing in speed. Historically, this was an important consideration in horary and medical inquiries.[1]

Hellenistic texts used the phrases *additive in numbers* and *subtractive in numbers* when discussing a planet's motion. Generally, *additive in numbers* referred to a planet in direct motion, and *subtractive in numbers* referred to a planet in retrograde motion. However, arguments can also be made for these terms being used to indicate a planet increasing or decreasing its speed. However, this notion is more accurately called *moving towards the greater or lesser extent of a planet's course.*

INTERPRETING SPEED AND DIRECTION

> And if [the stars] occupy the first station and are found to be stepping backwards, the matters that were previously determined, actions, profits, and undertakings are delayed. Likewise, even if the stars rise at sunset (acronychal), they are weak, thwarting, foretelling only illusions and hopes. And if, in any way, they come to the second station, they remove the hindrances, restore the same matters, and they bring stability and successful accomplishment of the livelihood. But if they are carried under the setting phase, they bring hindrances and troubles in what is being accomplished, and also bodily dangers, weaknesses,

1 You can also determine the planet's daily motion by looking at an ephemeris. Subtract the longitude of a planet (as given in degrees and minutes) from its position on the day before. This figure tells you the distance it has traveled within a twenty-four hour period. You can then compare this to its average to assess its relative average speed on that day. If you then subtract the longitude of the planet's position on the following day, you can compare the two sums and see whether the figure on the day after is larger or smaller than the figure on the day before. This will tell you if the planet is speeding up or slowing down. If the number is larger than the day before, the planet's speed is increasing. If it is smaller than on the day before, the planet's speed is decreasing.

CHART II: ENCLOSURE, CONTAINMENT, INTERVENTION

	Degree range	*Enclosed*	*Contained*	*Intervention*
MALEFICS	9°–12°	None	None	None
BENEFICS	4–23°	Mars	None	Saturn intervenes. Mars is not bonified.

→ EXERCISE 35

Using your own chart, complete exercise 35:
Maltreatment and Bonification by Enclosure or Containment